Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Exploring Text Structures

"Text structure" is the term for how an author organizes information. Authors use different text structures to achieve different purposes, and one piece of writing often has multiple text structures.

Directions: Common text structures are listed in the boxes on the right. Use the information in these boxes to help you answer the questions below about the text structures in "Disaster in Space."

1. The author uses **description** in the section "A Mission to the Moon." What is the author describing?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. A. In the section "Something Unexpected," the author explains why many Americans lost interest in space travel. Circle the text structure she used to do this.

problem and solution **cause and effect**

B. Explain how you know, using evidence from the text.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Description or List
Includes details to help you picture or get to know a person, a place, a thing, or an idea

Cause and Effect
Explains *why* something happened (cause) and *what* happened as a result (effect)

Problem and Solution
Presents a problem and explains how it is solved

Compare and Contrast
Presents the similarities and/or differences between two items, such as a pair of events, time periods, ideas, or places

Sequence of Events
Describes events in the order in which they happen (also called chronological order)

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3. The section "Scanning the Sky" presents solutions to the problems the Apollo 13 astronauts encountered during their mission. Write two problem-solution pairs below.

Problem 1

_____

Solution 1:

_____

Problem 2:

_____

Solution 2:

_____

4. A. *In t*he last section, "Free Fall to Earth," the author describes the events of the morning of April 17, 1970. Which text structure does she use?

_____

B. Explain how you know, using evidence from the text.

_____

_____

_____

C. The mood of this section is suspenseful. How does the text structure you identified help the writer create suspense?

_____

_____

_____

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